

Discolouration will matter if you want to go for clear tubing. Over time, the tubes tend to turn yellow and look straight up ugly. It won't matter if you use a clear coolant or coloured one if the tubing starts discolouring. This is why you should go for high-quality PVC or simply go for opaque coloured tubing.

You'll find more options in hard tubing materials where two of them are primarily used by builders. You'll come across acrylic (plexiglass) and PETG (polyethylene terephthalate glycol-modified), both with their own set of properties. The reason they are more popular is because they can be cut and bent with simple tools right at home. After selecting hard tubing for your build, you will have to finalise the material. Acrylic is clearer and more scratch-resistant than PETG. Hence, when you're adding coloured coolant in PETG tubing, you will need to verify whether you're achieving the desired shade. So, your loops will actually look better and close to glass with acrylic. However, it can be a pain to work with. PETG has a comparatively lower melting point so you don't need to hold it too long over the heat gun. This also makes the entire process of bending quicker. Acrylic is mostly neutral to all sorts of coolants but that isn't the case with PETG. When you're looking for coolants, you will have to check whether they are compatible with PETG tubing. Finally, acrylic is more brittle so it tends to crack easily. Even slight bumps to your build can potentially crack the



Different varieties of acrylic hard tubing

Credit: Bit-tech